

In the split second before she shuts her eyes to feign incapacitation, Vilde sees Ayo skulking behind the guards. The knights leave the rogue slumped in the chair as they wait for her to wake up once again.

As they do so, they see a tiny, shimmering rabbit clamber up to them. The rabbit waves a cheeky hello as dozens of other glowing rabbits explode out from it, searing the guards.

Seizing the opportunity, Vilde tries to undo her shackles, which remain stubbornly fastened. She casts *Druidcraft*, mimicking the False Hydra's song in the hopes of convincing the knights that the False Hydra is back.

While one of the guards believes it, the other knight slaps the naive guy and points to Vilde. Still surprised by the *Spirit Guardians*, the knights do not see Raphael coming. Thick, purple tentacles erupt from the black granite, restraining the arms of the two knights and bringing them to their knees.

Ayo, Gaya and Hazel rush up, helping to undo Vilde's manacles. She dons her armour and equipment again, glaring down at the captives.

"I don't need both of you," Vilde roars. "What does she want with me?"

A Coup at Camp Vengeance

Wang Lei, Salazar, Wukong, Yandala and Thaisha find Breakbones, who updates them about their preparations. She suggests that her men will handle the guards outside, thereby isolating the tent and stopping reinforcements. The Party can then strike at the Castellan, who has four knights inside with her.

Wang Lei tells Thaisha about their Party down in the False Hydra's lair, rescuing Vilde and asks Firebeard to direct them into the tent. He also realizes that Benedict Luxjaro and his attendant are nowhere to be seen in the camp, which means they might be in the Commanders' Tent.

Thaisha volunteers to sneak in and scout the place while wildshaped as a rat. Wang Lei says he has a different plan, and tells them to get ready outside the tent and charge in when he calls the codeword.

While the rest busy themselves with the upcoming coup, Salazar decides to take back his *Boots of Elvenkind*.

Wisdom (Animal Handling) Check

On a successful **DC 15** check, he calms Princess down and receives his boots back. On a **DC 20**, he notices the *loun stone of Intellect* and pockets it.

Wang Lei enters the tent, heading straight for the guards. He asks to speak to the Castellan, explaining that it is urgent. The guards acquiesce, letting him into the room.

Jack, the halfling knight, and Lyara Porter both appear, dressed in simple robes. Lyara speaks up immediately, asking "what is the matter, sugar?"

"I thought a lot about what you said," Wang Lei says. "I think it is too dangerous for you to be queen of this continent." He turns, shouting the codewords 'LET THEM EAT CAKE!' Thick, dark smoke billows out from him as the paladin casts *Darkness*, obscuring everything in the room. Panicked shouts ring out as Wang Lei reaches forward to try and seize Blackrazor, but is a mere second too late.

The Assassination of Lyara Porter

Initiative	Monster	Quantity	AC	HP	Remarks
16	Lyara Porter	1	16	178	-
17	Eldritch Knights	5	18	52	-
8	Benedict Luxjaro	1	16	81	-
5	Charity	1	17	105	-

On that rallying cry, Salazar charges in with the rest of the Party. Noticing a knight in the stables, he shouts "Daddy's back!" as he lets loose a *Fire Bolt*, searing the back of the knight. Confused, the knight turns and slams the hilt of his greatsword at the wizard before slashing down at him, drawing blood.

"The queen!" The knights upstairs shout. "She's under attack!" The pair stumble into the dark, only to see two pinpricks of dark light staring back at them. They are greeted with a swing of the mace, which thuds into the chest of the first knight, stopping him dead in his tracks.

Terrified, Lyara Porter breaks a spell glyph, as three identical *Mirror Images* appear around her.

Downstairs, Wukong and Yandala joins the fight. The paladin swings his Jingubang and knocks the knight prone as the sorcerer casts *Haste*. Thaisha sprints up the stairs, seeking to close distance.

Benedict Luxjaro and Charity, having heard the commotion, exit from their room and see darkness swirling in the Castellan's room. As they move towards it, Benedict stops abruptly as he receives a *Message* from an arriving Raphael.

"Wait," Raphael warns. "We're doing a mutiny and I'll explain later, trust me."

Charisma (Persuasion) Check

On a successful **DC 15** check, he succeeds in convincing the scion of House Luxjaro to stand down for now.

The knight in the stable continues to engage the wizard Salazar, who has ventured too close. As he brings his greatsword down on Salazar, thunderous energy wreathes the wizard, stopping him from moving.

Upstairs, the two knights surge in to the room, trying to find the attacking Wang Lei. Stumbling and swinging wildly in the dark, their weapons do not find purchase.

Panicked, Lyara Porter makes the devastating mistake of running deeper into the room. As she dashes out of the darkness, Wang Lei slams his mace into the back of one of her illusory duplicates, knocking it out of existence. She screams desperately, asking "why are they doing this?"

The incredibly dexterous Hazel leaps up onto the second floor in a single bound. She summons a *Fire Bolt* and tosses it, searing the back of the head of one of the knights.

Dexterity (Stealth) Check

On an unsuccessful **DC 16** check, both Benedict and Charity realize that the harregon is a cleric of Saleander.

Vilde fires a line of *Web* from her gauntlet and flips up to the second floor, throwing her dagger as she flies and missing the knight's neck by inches.

As Thaisha continues to dash towards the room, Benedict casts *Hold Person* on the cleric as golden chains erupt from the ground around and restrain Hazel. Charity fires two *Eldritch Blasts* at the cleric, concussing her.

In a swirl of mist, Raphael vanishes and reappears on the second floor. A psychic lance of power strikes into the knight, who resists it. The knight swings his greatsword down against the sorcerer, but it glances helplessly off a purple forcefield.

Salazar does the same, apparating onto the second floor before firing another *Fire Bolt* back at the knight in the stable. Trying to get out of danger, the knight casts *Thunderwave*. Concussive, booming energy erupts out from him, but Wukong stands his ground.

In the dark room, the paladin takes on three knights himself. Wang Lei ducks and weaves in the shadows, evading the blows of the knights and reciprocating with swings of his own mace. Bringing it down with his full weight, the paladin caves in the head of one of the knights as he leaps onto the table and hammers Jack, the halfling paladin.

Wukong finishes his skirmish with the knight in the stable as he slams the Jingubang with full force into the knight's chest, caving in his armour. He sprints, leaping up the stairs three at a time as he rushes to the centre of gravity of the fight.

Vilde lunges forward as she slashes the back of the knight and sinks her dagger deep into his abdomen. As the knight screams, Raphael silences him forever with *Tasha's Mind Whip* as a psychic lash closes around the knight's throat and stop his breathing.

Thaisha rushes up to the harregon cleric, casting *Lesser Restoration* to free Hazel. Seeing this, Benedict's eyes glow green as he summons necrotic, ghastly lions with *Spirit Guardians*. He draws a massive, deep red iron maul with a glowing sapphire in its centre and advances on Hazel.

Watching Charity charge up her *Fireball* spell, Raphael *Counterspells*. A psychic blast of energy fires towards the warlock, only to be caught at the last second by Benedict who has fired his own *Counterspell*. Roaring flames streak towards the other side of the tent, engulfing Hazel, Salazar and Thaisha in the blaze.

The wizard, not wanting to be outdone, reciprocates with a *Fireball* of his own. Charity leaps out of the way at the last second as the searing inferno scorches them both.

Back in darkness, the remaining two knights try to find the phantom paladin. They both cast *Thunderwave*, but Wang Lei merely shrugs off the concussive blast. Dark, burning energy swirls around the mace as Wang Lei brings it down on the halfling's head, stunning him.

Hazel summons her illusion as she runs from an obsessed Benedict. Spectral, glowing rabbits appear as the illusion summons *Spirit Guardians* of her own, smiting the sorcerer. Thaisha rushes to her aid, healing her with *Cure Wounds*.

Vilde slips into the darkness, her hungry eyes looking for the Castellan. She taps open her wukka nut, illuminating the space around her. Wang Lei spins her around, whispering to her and helping with the rogue's aim. She sends the dagger flying into the dark, only for it to return bloodless.

Outside, Wukong charges forward and engages with the sorcerer hellbent on killing the cleric. The spectral lions sink their teeth into Wukong as Benedict brings down *Tansul's Mace*, as the simian raises his shield at the last second. Salazar attempts to casts *Hold Person* on Benedict, who resists the spell by the sheer might of his will.

Charity summons another *Fireball* again, releasing a roaring torrent of flame at those gathered. Salazar leaps forward as he controls the blast, whirling it into a massive ball of fire and inhaling it. Raphael seizes the opportunity and casts *Suggestion* on Charity, telling her to 'stop fighting.'

Hazel summons her *Thorn Whip*, lashing out at Benedict. Wukong strikes at the sorcerer, landing a powerful blow in his chest. As Benedict stumbles back on uneasy feet, Thaisha ends the sorcerer with a *Fire Bolt*.

Watching her master go down, the tiefling lets loose a gutwrenching scream. Salazar casts *Hold Person* to stop her from escaping, but the warlock resists the spell. Charity leaps off the balcony into the first floor and sprints out of the Commander's tent.

Back in the office, as the knights escape out from *Darkness*, the paladin drops the spell and casts it again in the main bedroom. He and Vilde then closes distance, entering the room to continue their assassination.

"Where are you?" Vilde says in a sing-song voice. Relying herself at the door, she throws the dagger once more into the dark and finds the halfling paladin. The dagger pierces through Jack's neck, leaving him to collapse and drown in his own blood.

The last remaining paladin casts *Thunderwave*, missing both Vilde and Wang Lei by inches. Lyara Porter tries to sprint past both the rogue and the paladin, but Vilde's scimitar finds her last *Mirror Image* and cuts through it like butter.

Wang Lei's mace collides with the real Lyara Porter's chest, stopping her in her tracks. Wang Lei brings his mace down ferociously, pulverising the Castellan in rapid blows. As the paladin executes his former superior, Vilde duels with the last knight, holding him at bay.



The Party dashes in to the room as the knight casts another *Thunderwave*, but Wang Lei merely shrugs off the damage. The helpless Lyara gets up and tries to make a run for it, only to be stunned as Wang Lei's mace connects with the back of her head. She swings her sword wildly at Wang Lei, who blocks it with his shield.

The ruthless paladin continues the relentless assault, landing blow after blow on the weeping and shrieking Castellan. As the rest of the Party enters the room, Lyara Porter stands unsteadily to her feet, her face covered in blood. She raises her sword and strikes at Vilde, only to be stopped mid-swing by Wang Lei. The paladin slams his mace with full force onto the crown of her skull, dashing the Castellan's brains in a spray of blood all over the room.